Data Protection and Retention Policy

Example Manufacturing GmbH. Document DP-02, version 1.4, owner: Data Protection Officer (DPO), effective 15 September 2025.

1. Purpose and Scope

This policy implements the requirements of the EU General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR) and the German Federal Data Protection Act (BDSG) for all processing of personal data by the company.

2. Principles

Personal data is processed lawfully, for specified purposes, limited to what is necessary, kept accurate, stored no longer than needed and protected by appropriate security measures.

3. Records of Processing Activities

Each department maintains its entries in the record of processing activities (Art. 30 GDPR) and updates them within 30 days of any change to a processing activity.

4. Data Protection Impact Assessment

A data protection impact assessment (DPIA) is carried out before any new processing that is likely to result in a high risk to the rights and freedoms of people. The DPO must be consulted. A DPIA is reviewed every 3 years or when the processing changes significantly.

5. Retention Periods

Personal data is deleted when the retention period ends. The standard retention periods are:

• Data of unsuccessful applicants: deleted 6 months after the end of the application process, unless the applicant agreed to be kept in the talent pool, which is limited to 2 years.

• Invoices and accounting vouchers: 8 years. Ledgers and annual financial statements: 10 years.

• CCTV recordings at the plant gates: 72 hours, unless they are needed to investigate an incident.

• Visitor registration logs: 3 months.

• System logs that contain personal data: 90 days. Security logs: 12 months.

• Customer contact data in the CRM: 3 years after the last business contact.

6. Deletion and Disposal

Deletion is automated where possible and is logged. Paper documents with personal data are shredded to at least security level P-4 according to DIN 66399. Storage media are wiped or destroyed by the certified disposal provider.

7. Data Subject Requests

Requests from people exercising their rights, such as access, correction or deletion, are forwarded to the DPO within 2 working days. The company answers within one month of receipt, as required by Art. 12(3) GDPR.

8. Personal Data Breaches

Every suspected personal data breach must be reported to the DPO and to IT Security immediately and in any case within 24 hours of discovery. The DPO decides whether the breach must be notified to the supervisory authority, which has to happen within 72 hours (Art. 33 GDPR). Affected people are informed when the breach is likely to result in a high risk to them (Art. 34 GDPR).

9. International Transfers

Personal data is transferred outside the EU and EEA only on the basis of an adequacy decision or the EU standard contractual clauses, and only with the approval of the DPO.